

- Formula: Situation -> Complication -> Question -> Answer
- Move: frame context, name the complication, make the question explicit and then answer it
- Minimum: Situation: X. Complication: Y. Question: what should we do? Answer: Z.
- Best for: briefings, proposals, strategy narratives, presentations and problem framing
- Avoid when: over-dramatising simple issues or withholding the answer when the listener needs speed
- Failure mode: manufacturing drama instead of clarifying the real problem
- Neighbour: BLUF - Use SCQA when the Situation -> Complication -> Question -> Answer structure is the main need; use BLUF when that adjacent move better serves the moment.
- Neighbour: PREP - Use SCQA when the Situation -> Complication -> Question -> Answer structure is the main need; use PREP when that adjacent move better serves the moment.